Preface

This book outlines the basic issues and key concepts of group process and shows how group leaders can apply these concepts in working with a variety of groups. In many ways this is a "how-to" book, but it is also a book about the "why" of group leadership.

When a new edition of one of our books appears, professors often ask, "What is new about this edition?" The philosophy of group work in this book has been consistent since our first edition in 1977. However, this tenth edition of *Groups: Process and Practice* contains many subtle changes in our discussion of the topics within each chapter, and many chapters have undergone considerable revision with new material added. Our thinking has been refined through our group work practice and teaching over the past 40 years (since the original edition), and we have attempted to bring each new edition in line with current practices in the field.

Beginning with the eighth edition we added the contributions of coauthor Cindy Corey, who brings her expertise in multicultural counseling to the practice of group work and to this book. Cindy has integrated current applications of diversity to the practice of group work and has expanded on the topics presented in earlier editions. Many reviewers, and the results survey by users of this book, indicated that they value the practical aspect of *Groups*, and they suggested that we add even more clinical examples to bring the topics of discussion to life. This tenth edition contains many new and expanded examples with a focus on diversity in group work.

What's New in the Tenth Edition of *Groups: Process and Practice*

For the tenth edition, each chapter has been carefully revised and updated to present the current thinking and trends in practice. The following description of the various parts of the book highlights material that has been added, updated, expanded, or revised for the tenth edition.

In Part One we deal with the basic issues in group work; these themes are addressed in the first four chapters:

- Chapter 1 (Introduction to Group Work: A Multicultural Perspective) presents an overview of various types of groups, including an updated discussion of brief groups, as well as our perspective on multicultural group work and becoming a culturally skilled group practitioner, which contains some new material.

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- Chapter 2 (The Group Counselor) addresses the group counselor as a person and as a professional, and topics are illustrated with many examples. This chapter addresses the skills of group leadership and the coleadership model. There is new material on research trends in group work and ways that research can enhance one's group practice, with particular emphasis on common factors such as the therapeutic relationship.
- Chapter 3 (Ethical and Legal Issues in Group Counseling) has been revised to conform to the 2014 *ACA Ethics Code* as applied to group work. The chapter covers updated material on the ethical and legal aspects of group counseling, as well as ethical issues in training group workers with the use of experiential groups, assessing competence, and managing multiple roles and relationships in teaching group counseling courses. Featured in this chapter are social justice issues in group work and ethical concerns when using group techniques.
- Chapter 4 (Theories and Techniques of Group Counseling) highlights the relationship between theory and technique and addresses topics such as theory as a roadmap, using techniques effectively, and developing an integrative approach to group practice. This chapter is organized by four general theories: psychodynamic approaches, experiential and relationship-oriented approaches, cognitive behavioral approaches, and postmodern approaches to group counseling. Specific theoretical perspectives on the practice of group work include psychoanalytic therapy, Adlerian therapy, existential therapy, person-centered approach, Gestalt therapy, psychodrama, behavior therapy, cognitive therapy, cognitive behavior therapy, rational emotive behavior therapy, reality therapy, solution-focused brief therapy, narrative therapy, motivational interviewing, feminist therapy, and multicultural perspectives. The motivational interviewing section is new to this edition. Also included is a brief discussion of how to develop an integrative approach to group counseling.

In Part Two separate chapters deal with group process issues for each phase in the evolution of a group. These issues include designing a group and getting one started, working effectively with a coleader at each stage of a group, member roles and leader functions, problems that can occur at different times in a group, and techniques and procedures for facilitating group process. In Chapters 5 through 9 we have included a consideration of how diversity influences both the process and outcomes of groups, and new examples from a diversity perspective illustrate key challenges for each of the stages in a group's development. Special features in Chapters 5 through 9 that are new to this edition include the following:

Critical Incidents illustrates a situation associated with a stage in the group. The situation is briefly described, questions are raised, clinical reflections are given, and possible interventions to address the incident are suggested. The aim is to stimulate discussion in class on how to critically analyze the critical incident. The primary goal of this activity is to provide a clinical context for the material covered throughout the chapter.

Learning in Action presents activities integrated within the chapters that can be used with the entire class, in small groups, or at home. These activities are intended to have multiple uses in academic settings, and many are appropriate to use in clinical settings with group members as well.

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Journal Prompts are a way to further the professional and personal development of the reader and may also be used with group members in a clinical setting throughout various stages of a group.

- Chapter 5 (Forming a Group) demonstrates how important careful thought and planning are in laying a solid foundation for any group. The factors we emphasize include designing a proposal for a group, attracting members, screening and selecting members, and the orientation process.
- Chapter 6 (Initial Stage of a Group) addresses specific group process concepts during the early phase of a group's development. There is a discussion of cultural considerations, dealing with a hidden agenda, the role of leader self-disclosure, and ways to create trust early in a group.
- Chapter 7 (Transition Stage of a Group) offers a reframing and reconceptualization of resistance and provides ideas related to understanding and working with difficult group behaviors therapeutically. There is more emphasis on understanding and honoring clients' resistance and new material on motivational interviewing as a way to address ambivalence and increase motivation to change. We highlight the necessity of understanding how cultural factors can account for behavioral manifestations that may appear to be problematic behavior and consider conflict and confrontation from a cultural perspective. There are more examples of both leader behavior and member behavior pertaining to dealing with mistrust in a group and how to increase trust. An expanded discussion of the role of transference and countertransference includes guidelines for dealing effectively with countertransference.
- Chapter 8 (Working Stage of a Group) includes an expanded discussion of the therapeutic factors operating in a group. Factors given special attention include member self-disclosure, guidelines for leader self-disclosure, feedback, confrontation, and group cohesion.
- Chapter 9 (Final Stage of a Group) entails a discussion on the tasks of terminating a group experience. Increased emphasis is given to dealing with emotional reactions pertaining to termination and to addressing unfinished business in a group.

Part Two includes numerous examples that illustrate a variety of leader interventions in response to the problems often encountered in facilitating a group. We tie in the theoretical approaches covered in Chapter 4 to the various topics in the stages of a group. We also have linked the group proposals described in Chapters 10 and 11 to selected topics so readers can see practical examples of the concepts being discussed. Each chapter in this section contains a summary of the characteristics of the particular stage along with member functions and leader functions at each stage of group development. The chapters conclude with several exercises that can be done either at home or in the classroom. We have integrated citations to relevant research when it was available, and we draw on our own experience in group work for personal examples and share our perspectives on the topics we explore. We have attempted to keep the reader-friendly writing style that students say they appreciate.

In Part Three we show how the basic concepts examined in Part Two can be applied to specific types of groups in the schools and in community agency settings. We offer guidelines for group leaders who want to design groups specifically for children, adolescents, adults, and older adults in different settings.

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The 12 group proposals focus on the unique needs of each kind of group and how to meet those needs.

- Chapter 10 (Groups in School Settings) includes five group proposals for children and adolescents. This chapter consolidates material from two chapters in earlier editions and gives increased attention to the guidelines for group work with children and adolescents.
- Chapter 11 (Groups in Community Settings) features seven group proposals for adult groups at various developmental stages and with particular life issues. A new group proposal on treating people with substance use disorders has been added.

This edition of *Groups* is aligned with the CACREP 2016 Standards for Group Counseling and Group Work; all of the chapters address specific standards. We have added learning objectives for all of the chapters, with specific attention given to the CACREP standards identified for each chapter.

Groups: Process and Practice is intended for graduate and undergraduate students majoring in psychology, sociology, counseling, clinical mental health counseling, social work, marriage and family therapy, education, and human services who are taking courses in group counseling or group leadership. Others who may find this book useful in their work are social workers, rehabilitation counselors, teachers, pastoral counselors, correctional workers, and marriage and family therapists.

Ancillaries

We have developed a self-study DVD program and workbook combination titled *Groups in Action: Evolution and Challenges* that can be used as an integrated learning package with *Groups: Process and Practice*. This self-study program consists of three parts. The first program, *Evolution of a Group* (2 hours) depicts central features that illustrate the development of the group process and how the coleaders facilitated that process as the group moved through the various stages: initial, transition, working, and ending. The second program, *Challenges for Group Leaders* (90 minutes) demonstrates ways to work therapeutically with a variety of difficult behaviors in groups and approaches to addressing diversity issues in group counseling. The third program contains *Lecturettes on Theories and Techniques of Group Counseling* (1 hour) by Jerry Corey. An overview of the various theories and their application to techniques in group work are discussed here. The *Workbook* that accompanies this video program includes key points and questions for reflection on the lecturettes on theories and techniques of group counseling. The videos and the workbook are designed to be an integrated package. This program utilizes an interactive format and requires students to become active learners as they study the group process in action.

Groups: Process and Practice comes with MindTap, an online learning solution created to harness the power of technology to drive student success. This cloud-based platform integrates a number of learning applications ("apps") into an easy-to-use and easy-to-access tool that supports a personalized learning experience. MindTap combines student learning tools—readings, multimedia, activities, and

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assessments—into a singular Learning Path that guides students through the course. This MindTap includes:

- Original videos modeling specific group counseling skills in simulated group scenarios
- Self-assessments, reflection questions, discussion activities, and case studies
- Interactive Helper Studio video exercises
- Discussion questions and activities that allow students to collaborate with their peers to develop solutions and responses in an online environment
- Chapter quizzes at the end of each chapter
- A glossary and flashcards of key terms and concepts

An *Instructor's Resource Manual* for this tenth edition of *Groups: Process and Practice* is also available. It contains multiple-choice test items, essay exam questions, questions for reflection and discussion, additional exercises and activities, guidelines for using the *Groups in Action: Evolution and Challenges* program with this book, reading suggestions for instructors in preparing classes, a survey of current practices in teaching group counseling courses, power point lecture slides, and examples of course outlines. We also describe our approach to workshops in training and supervising group leaders, which can be incorporated in many group courses.

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Finally, as is true of all our books, *Groups: Process and Practice* continues to develop as a result of a team effort, which includes the combined efforts of several people at Cengage Learning: Jon Goodspeed, Product Director; Julie Martinez, Product Manager, Counseling, Social Work, & Human Services; Alexander Hancock, Associate Content Developer, Sociology, Counseling, and Social Work; Vernon Boes, Art Director; Jeanne Calabrese for her work on the interior design and cover of this book; and Rita Jaramillo, Content Project Manager. Thanks to Ben Kolstad of Cenveo Publisher Services, who coordinated the production of this book. Special recognition goes to Kay Mikel, the manuscript editor of this edition, whose exceptional editorial talents continue to keep this book reader friendly. Susan Cunningham updated the *Instructor's Resource Manual* and other supplements, created and revised test items to accompany this text, and prepared the index. The efforts and dedication of all of these people have contributed to the high quality of this edition.

Marianne Schneider Corey
Gerald Corey
Cindy Corey

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Groups

PROCESS AND PRACTICE

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